

# Nearby stars

Our nearest star is the Sun. It seems a very long way away, yet the Sun's light takes just over eight minutes to reach us. The light from our next-nearest star, Proxima Centauri, doesn't get to the Earth for more than four years.

The Sun contains 99.8 per cent of the total mass of the solar system.

## Light years away

Astronomers measure space distance in light years, because the distances are so great that normal measurements have little meaning. A light year is the distance light travels in a year.

